

technology. The AIC will provide technology support for training students in the drone technician trade programme at ITI. The collaboration aims to benefit both students and startups at AIC by leveraging the large infrastructure at ITI for product development.

Qualcomm joins forces with C-DAC for Digital India futureLABS Initiative

Qualcomm and MeitY's C-DAC collaborate to strengthen India's semiconductor design ecosystem. Qualcomm will provide expertise, technology, intellectual property, tools, and skill development to promote Design in India and Make in India initiatives. This will stimulate the indigenous development of SoCs for high-volume products. C-DAC aims to establish Digital India futureLABS to enhance the national R&D landscape in sectors like automotive, computers, communications, strategic electronics, and industrial electronic/IoT.

Microsoft to provide AI training to two million Indians

Microsoft's CEO Satya Nadella has announced that the company aims to provide AI training opportunities to two million people in India by 2025. This initiative focuses on reaching individuals in tier-2 and tier-3 cities, as well as rural areas. He highlighted the efforts of Karya, an AI startup, which engages rural Indians in creating datasets to train large language models in 12 Indian languages.

DST invites institutions to establish T-hubs for NQM

The Department of Science and Technology of the government of India has invited pre-proposals (white papers) from academic and R&D institutions to establish four thematic hubs (T-hubs) for the National Quantum Mission (NQM) in consortia format. These T-hubs will focus on quantum computing, quantum communication, quantum sensing & meteorology, and quantum materials & devices. The NQM aims to develop the quantum technology ecosystem in India with a budget of 60.04 billion rupees over eight years.

SNIPPETS



- OLA Electric Founder Bhavish Aggarwal's artificial intelligence startup Krutrim AI reaches \$1 billion or more valuation landmark to become India's first AI Unicorn
- CESC seeks to acquire 50,000 acres of land in Rajasthan and Gujarat to fuel its 3GW hybrid renewable energy portfolio
- IT Minister Rajeev Chandrasekhar inaugurated Synopsys' Chip Design Centre at DLF Tech Park in Noida
- Tata Motors commences operations on its gigafactory project in Somerset, UK; financial arrangements for the project are currently being finalised.
- Drone Vidya and USI to boost Asian drone workforce
- Japan's industry ministry announces \$307 million worth of subsidies to develop optical technology for use in semiconductor chips
- The US to announce multi-billion dollar semiconductor subsidies to support the construction of new factories in the United States
- Teradyne shifts manufacturing worth \$1 billion out of China amid US export controls

Tata Elxsi unveils new global design and engineering centre in Pune

Tata Elxsi has inaugurated a new global design and engineering centre in Sukhwani Business Hub, Chinchwad, Pune. The centre is designed to meet the technological and digital transformation needs of major automotive OEMs and tier-1 suppliers. It will accommodate over 1000 engineers, designers, and technology experts, with laboratories for joint efforts in engineering research and development in areas of software defined vehicles, connected services, autonomous technologies, electrification, mechatronics, and design.

Antolin inaugurates plant for automotive electronic solutions in Pune

Antolin inaugurated its new facility in Pune on January 18, 2023, marking its first plant in India. The facility, located in the automotive hub of Chakan, Pune, spans 3200 square metres and will focus on manufacturing integrated lighting, HMI systems, and electronic solutions for top vehicle makers in India. The plant is expected to create jobs for 200 skilled workers within two years.

Government plans to install rooftop solar panels on ten million houses

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the launch of the *Pradhanmantri Suryodaya Yojana*, aiming

to install rooftop solar panels on ten million houses nationwide. This initiative is expected to reduce electricity bills and contribute to India's self-reliance in the energy sector. India's National Rooftop Scheme under MNRE provides financial support covering 40% of the capital cost for solar rooftop projects, targeting low- and middle-income individuals.

Maharashtra to increase solar power capacity for agriculture

Maharashtra is amplifying its solar power initiatives through the KUSUM (Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahaabhiyan) programme. The programme seeks to increase solar power capacity in the agricultural sector by deploying solar panels and pumps on farmlands, providing a reliable and renewable energy source for irrigation. The programme offers incentives and subsidies to improve the economic feasibility for farmers to adopt solar technology.

India expects 30% revenue rise from telecom sector

According to the Interim Budget, the government expects to generate ₹1.2 trillion in revenue from the telecom sector for the fiscal year 2025, a 30% increase from the revised revenue target of ₹935.41 billion for FY24. This growth is expected to be driven by an upcoming spectrum auction and higher adjusted gross revenue payments from telecom companies in FY25.